

Break on through to the other side!



Why hasn't Linux invaded our lives? We take a look at the Linux penetration in Indian offices, and the different projects and programmes that look to introduce Open Source Solutions

Linux! Say the word amidst a crowd of computer novices, and you will witness a vanishing act. Linux has developed an image of being extremely complicated, and for most general users, a major headache. This is the primary reason why Linux is not even considered an operating system for the home user, despite its crucial advantage—cost-effectiveness. The same is the case for corporations and employees. Why lose out on productivity for no apparent reason?

But will this always be the scenario? Linux has been around for some time now. Hence the excuse that it is a relatively new entrant, and will take time to develop, now holds no weight.

OS on Steroids?

The major task of almost every PC is office productivity and games. On an average, the life expectancy of a PC in India is about 4 years. Now, consider upgrading your Windows every 2 to 3 years. This alone

would set you back by as much as Rs 6,500. And when you look at licensed application software, few go further than another flagship Microsoft offering: Office could cost you as much as Rs 15,000. What this effectively means is that in a year, you could easily spend up to Rs 5,000 on your PC. And if you work in a corporate environment, multiply that figure by the number of employees in your firm.

Linux cost savings are also helping create a cheaper computing environment